Gene Likens



Born in Indiana in 1935, Likens received his PhD in zoology and became an assistant professor at Dartmouth College. In 1963, with fellow scientists F. Herbert Bormann, Noye Johnson, and Robert Pierce, he began research into the water, minerals, and life forms in the Hubbard Brook basin. In 1968, his studies recorded the widespread prevalence of acid rain, the product of emissions from factories in the Midwest. The team's work over many years was one of the most thorough studies of how air pollution and land use has shaped a drainage basin. Likens's work on deforestation, land use, and sustainability led to a change in policy by the US Forestry Service. It also helped shape the amended Clean Air Act in 1990. His many honors include the National Medal of Science, awarded in 2001, and the Benjamin Franklin Medal in 2019.

Key works

1985 *An Ecosystem Approach to Aquatic Ecology: Mirror Lake and its Environment*

1991 *Limnological Analyses*

See also: Endangered habitats • Pesticides • Deforestation • Depletion of natural resources • Ocean acidification